

Kunal Ninawe

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Full Stack Engineer · AI Product Engineer · Forward Deployed Engineer

Founding full-stack engineer at an AI-native finance startup after 4 years owning partner identity at Expedia. I ship customer-facing product end to end, measure before I fix, and build the tooling that lets a small team move at 40 PRs a week.

SKILLS

- **Frontend:** React 19, TypeScript, React Router v7 (SSR), Next.js, TanStack Query / Table / Virtual, Zustand, Tailwind, shadcn/ui, Vitest, RTL, MSW, Cypress, Playwright
- **Backend / platform:** Node.js, Express, BFF pattern, REST, GraphQL, OpenAPI codegen, zod, SSE, Go (ramping), Java, Python, Postgres, Redis, Kafka
- **Cloud / infra:** AWS (ECS, Lambda, S3, CloudFront), Docker, Kubernetes, GitHub Actions, Spinnaker, OIDC, CSP, Datadog, Splunk
- **AI engineering:** Claude Code agents, skills, hooks, MCP, context engineering, LLM product UX, eval-style CI checks, pdf.js extraction overlays

EXPERIENCE

OpenCFO, Seattle, WA · Founding Full Stack Engineer

Apr 2026 - Present

- Owned the entire web app of an AI-native AP/AR automation platform (React Router v7 SSR, React 19, TypeScript) while the company went from 0 to 10 customers: 287 merged PRs (75% of the repo), 136 routes, 87 BFF endpoints, and 0 to 3,200 tests in 21 weeks.
- Migrated a localStorage-JWT SPA to SSR with a Backend-for-Frontend layer: httpOnly cookie auth, loader-enforced RBAC (27 permissions), per-request nonce CSP, immutable-SHA ECS deploys. Wrote the engineering blog post "We added a BFF layer before reaching for GraphQL".
- Worked directly with customer finance and engineering teams (Epicor Prophet 21 distributor): turned call transcripts into a 12-doc spec, shipped invoice / PO / goods-receipt three-way matching in ~25 PRs against a pulled-forward demo, and wrote 12 backend requirement docs the backend team built against.
- Traced 2.5s of main-thread blocking from production Chrome traces and removed it: pdf.js text layer 1.2s to 0, 226 tooltip providers to 1, PDF canvas 58MB to 8.8MB, layout pass 12.7x faster, match API 1,087ms to 738ms, a 9,999-row fetch and an N+1 approvals storm to zero.
- Found and fixed a cross-user data leak through the browser HTTP cache (44 routes, CI source-scan test) and a logout race; proved mid-session sign-outs were a backend one-session-per-user design and wrote the requirements doc instead of a workaround.
- Built the team's agentic engineering system on Claude Code: 26 skills, 3 review subagents, 9 hooks, machine-checked design manifests with a CI review boundary, an authenticated-browser handoff for agents, and an OpenAPI spec-sync bot. Peak: 40 PRs merged in one week.
- Shipped AI product surfaces: PDF field-highlight overlay synced to extracted fields, AI email composer and Ask AI for collections, a live SSE notification inbox, streamed extraction progress for uploads, and an AP inbox agent demo built in 4 days for a prospect.

Expedia Group, Seattle, WA · Software Engineer II

May 2022 - Apr 2026

- Owned end-to-end delivery of partner identity workflows (login, MFA, password and email reset, account disable) in React, TypeScript, GraphQL, OAuth 2.0 / OIDC, and ACR step-up auth for ~100K partners across 4 portals, with ~90% adoption and 6+ downstream teams.
- Led the Update Email initiative: found that 4-5% of global users shared traveler and partner accounts at risk of lockout, designed the async API fixes and a Change Data Capture pipeline with downstream brand teams.
- Cut identity risk: resolved ~45% of partner identity mismatches, mitigated MFA toll fraud, and released auth changes through data-driven feature-flag rollouts, reducing deployment incidents ~25%.
- Raised production quality: 94% Jest coverage, Cypress e2e with real OTP simulation, L3 on-call with Splunk and Datadog, and RCA docs that reduced recurring support requests ~20%.

Global Traffic Technologies, Minneapolis, MN · Full Stack Engineer

Jun 2021 - Apr 2022

- Built cost-optimized backend APIs and batch workflows in Python on AWS Lambda, ECS, API Gateway, DynamoDB, ElastiCache, Kinesis Firehose, and CloudFormation; swapped DynamoDB for Redis on latency-sensitive paths.

PROJECTS

- **Invoice PDF Field Highlighter** (React 19, pdf.js, TypeScript): extracts 10 invoice fields from PDF text and maps PDF-space coordinates to on-screen highlights; precursor to the OpenCFO bill viewer. ninawekunal.github.io/pdf-highlighter
- **AgentPortal** (React, Hapi, Supabase, GraphQL): invoice-approval dashboard with cursor pagination, bulk approval, and lazy PDF review, deployed on Railway.

EDUCATION

New York University, MS Computer Engineering, May 2021 (TA, Intro to Java and Intro to Embedded Systems) · **University of Mumbai**, BS Computer and Information Science, Jul 2019